

Building resilience

Over time and with practice, teens can learn new behaviors and ways of thinking to help them keep going when things get tricky.

Encourage yourself

Don't give yourself a hard time. Instead, think positively and praise yourself when you achieve something, no matter how small.

Know your strengths

Thinking about what you're good at reminds you of what you have to offer.

Ask for help

Seek out people in a similar situation who may be able to support you. There is nothing wrong with asking for help.

Remember past challenges

Try to remember another time when you felt this way, what you did, and how you felt afterward.

Learn from others

Some of the greatest athletes, inventors, and writers suffered many disappointments and failures before achieving success. Take inspiration from their persistence.

Build a support network

Friends and family can listen and help with your concerns, or provide a great distraction.

Work toward a goal

Having a clear goal can give you something to work toward and focus your attention.

Behave proactively

Taking active steps to change a situation can give you a sense of control. Try doing things differently if it didn't work out the first time.

Think positively

Try out a different perspective. Aim to be more optimistic—a little humor can help.

Acknowledge your feelings

Reflect on and try to understand how you're feeling. In doing so, it might become clear what steps you need to take to change things.

TEEN HINTS

Adapting to change

As a teen, it's common to encounter new situations where you may not feel entirely comfortable. Part of being resilient is being able to cope with the feelings caused by such changes. It's okay to notice yourself being a bit anxious—anxiety helps you recognize when something is valuable to you. Try rehearsing the situation in advance or making a plan to help you feel more confident and prepared.

Stay healthy

Eating well and doing regular exercise can improve your mental state and strengthen your ability to cope with a difficult situation.

Appreciate the good things

Even the small things count, like listening to a favorite song or reading a good book.